

Classroom SEL pack, a week on guardianship, ages 3 to 7

The Littlest Guardian

A five-day plan with everything to print: word cards, a poster, a feelings chart, sequencing cards, activity cards, promise cards, an observation grid, exit tickets and family letters in five languages. The Home Activity Pack is included at the back.

Classroom licence: one teacher may print and copy this pack for their own class and students' families. Please don't share the file or post it online.

The week at a glance

About 20 to 30 minutes a day. Each day stands alone if you only have time for one.

Day	What you do	Print
Day 1 Read and learn the words	Read the story with the pause points. Teach the five words with gestures. Put up the poster and word cards.	Pages 3, 4, 5
Day 2 Feelings	Feelings check-in. Re-read the book and talk about how the characters felt, using the talk questions.	Pages 6, 9
Day 3 Retell	Mix up the sequencing cards and put the story back in order as a class. Retell with “First… Then… At the end…”.	Page 7
Day 4 Our classroom path	Scatter soft paper pieces on a tape path. Each child picks up one piece at a time, saying ‘start little’, until the path is clear. Then waddle along it saying ‘pitter-pat…	Page 8
Day 5 Glowing shell edges	Glowing shell edges, then promise cards and exit tickets. Send the family letter home.	Pages 8, 10, 14 to 16

Ontario Kindergarten frames

Belonging and Contributing, Self-Regulation and Well-Being, Demonstrating Literacy and Mathematics Behaviours, Problem Solving and Innovating

Materials

The book (or the class screen), small sticks or paper strips, white paper shells, a tape path on the floor

Also in this pack

All 12 pages of the Home Activity Pack (from page 17), which you may copy for your class. Book languages: English, French, Spanish, German, Italian.

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Day 1: the read-aloud

Before (3 minutes)

Show the cover. Ask: What kind of bird is this? Have you ever seen a penguin this small? Where do you think it lives? Ask: What is a place you love? Who looks after it? Take a few answers. Teach the refrain: pat your knees softly like little penguin feet. ‘Pitter-pat, pitter-pat.’

During: stop, ask, listen (10 minutes)

Spread	What happens	Ask	Listen for
2	The penguins waddle home up the sandy path.	Why is the path important to the penguins?	it takes them home, to their burrows
4	A storm covers the path; everyone grumbles.	Who should clean it up?	someone, everyone, the penguins
5	Tama says ‘It’s not my mess’, then helps a stuck chick.	Why did Tama say ‘It’s not my mess’?	he didn’t make it, it’s not his job
6	Tama lies awake thinking of grandmothers and chicks.	What changed Tama’s mind?	the chick, his grandma walked here, future chicks Go further: Does it matter whose mess it is?
7	‘Then I’ll start little.’	How can someone very small make a big difference?	a little at a time, one stick, every day
8	Aroha helps; nobody else notices.	Why did Tama keep going when nobody noticed?	he cared about the path, not about praise
10	Three chicks ask to help.	What did Tama teach the chicks?	start little, one stick each
11	The colony walks home; nobody trips.	How do you think Tama feels?	proud, happy, his heart is as big as the sea

Spread numbers match the reader on the class screen. You don’t need every stop.

Handle with care: Safety first for any tidy-up outdoors: gloves, a grown-up, and never touch anything sharp, glass, needles or fishing line. More notes on the “For every child” page.

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Word wall cards

Cut out and add to your word wall. Teach each word with its gesture.

path

a little track you walk along

Do it: walk two fingers across your arm

storm

strong wind and rain

Do it: wave your arms like wind

driftwood

wood the sea brings onto the beach

Do it: hold your arms out like a log

colony

a big group of animals that live together

Do it: wave your arms to show lots of friends

look after

to take care of something

Do it: hug your arms around something

Pitter-pat, pitter-pat.

Say it together whenever it comes up in the story.

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Look after the world, the way it looks after you.

Pitter-pat, pitter-pat.

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How do you feel today?

Post at circle time. Children clip a peg with their name on a face.
Characters' feelings change during a story, and ours can too.



happy

clip your name here



sad

clip your name here



worried

clip your name here



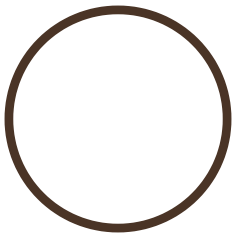
angry

clip your name here



proud

clip your name here



something else

clip your name here

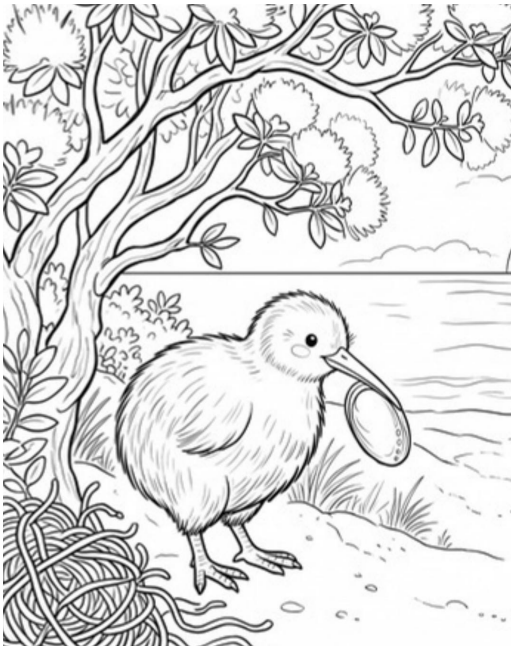
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Sequencing cards

Cut apart for the pocket chart. The four scenes come from the start, two middles and the end of the book, mixed up. Put them in order and retell. Children can color them too.









Answer key, top left to bottom right: 3, 1, 4, 2.

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Activity cards

Cut out and keep with the book. Use one on Day 4 and one on Day 5, or any time.

Our classroom path

10 minutes, Whole class, Materials: A tape path, soft paper ‘sticks’ and ‘seaweed’

Scatter soft paper pieces on a tape path. Each child picks up one piece at a time, saying ‘start little’, until the path is clear. Then waddle along it saying ‘pitter-pat’.

Glowing shell edges

15 minutes, Individual, Materials: White paper, scissors, a dark display board

Cut and decorate white shells. Line the edges of a paper path on the board so ‘everyone can find their way home’.

Little guardians job

5 minutes a day for a week, Whole class, Materials: A chart

Choose one small place in the classroom or yard to look after every day (the book corner, a planter). Tick the chart each day. Talk about how it looks at the end of the week.

Science and nature corner

Little blue penguins, called kororā in Māori, are the smallest penguins in the world, about 30 cm tall. They live around New Zealand and southern Australia, fish at sea during the day, and come ashore after dark, walking in groups to their burrows. Dogs, cats and traffic near beaches can harm them. Kiwi are birds found only in New Zealand; they can’t fly, come out at night and have nostrils at the very tip of their long beaks.

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Talk together

Use after reading, at circle time or with a small group. Accept every honest answer.

1. Why did Tama say ‘It’s not my mess’ at first?

Look for: He didn’t make it, so he didn’t think it was his job.

2. What made him change his mind?

Look for: Helping the chick and thinking about those who came before and after.

3. How can someone very small make a big difference?

Look for: By starting little and doing a bit every day.

4. Why did Tama keep going even when nobody noticed?

Look for: Because he cared about the path and everyone who uses it.

5. What place do you love that you could look after?

Look for: Any answer. Make a class list of places to care for.



Say it together

Pitter-pat, pitter-pat.

The big idea: Look after the places that look after you, a little every day, even if the mess isn’t yours.

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Promise cards

Each child writes or draws one way they can show guardianship this week. Hang them up, then check back on Friday.



I can show guardianship by

Name _____



I can show guardianship by

Name _____



I can show guardianship by

Name _____



I can show guardianship by

Name _____

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What to look for

Tick what you notice during the week. Each column names the Ontario frame it shows.

Child	Belonging and Contributing	Self-Regulation and Well-Being	Demonstrating Literacy and Mathematics Behaviours	Problem Solving and Innovating	Notes

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Science and place corner

The book's beach has no name, so we picked one where little penguins live and kiwi really walk on the sand: Stewart Island / Rakiura, at the bottom of New Zealand.



Little penguin (kororā)

Little penguins use their paddle-like flippers to 'fly' through the water at up to 6 km/h.



Rakiura tokoeka (Stewart Island kiwi)

A kiwi egg is about 20% of its mother's weight, and six times bigger than normal for a bird its size. The tokoeka's egg is pale green and about 13 cm long.



Little penguin chicks

In its first year, a young little penguin can travel more than 1,000 km.

Stewart Island / Rakiura, New Zealand

Tama: Real little penguins really do walk the same path home every night, all in a group. But a penguin with baby fluff on its head would still be a chick waiting at the nest, not out on the beach. And penguins don't tidy paths: people do that job for them.

Aroha: Rakiura tokoeka really do walk on beaches, sometimes in daylight. But real kiwi don't carry shells. Aroha's rainbow shell looks just like a pāua shell, a real New Zealand sea snail.

The three chicks: Real chicks stay hidden near the nest until they're ready for the sea. They wouldn't carry sticks along the path. The white feather on one chick's chest is our artist's idea.

Facts and sources: doubleadventure.ca/heroes/the-littlest-guardian

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For every child

English and French learners

Watch the read-aloud first. Teach the phrase ‘start little’ with a gesture (pinch your fingers). The refrain is a sound, so everyone can join in.

Children who need more support

Use three stops (spreads 4, 6 and 11). Act out the tidy path with real objects before reading.

Mixed ages and older children

Older children make a ‘before and after’ drawing of a place they looked after, and teach a younger buddy how to start little.

Handle with care

Safety first for any tidy-up outdoors: gloves, a grown-up, and never touch anything sharp, glass, needles or fishing line.

Don’t blame people for the mess or lecture about pollution. In the story, the mess comes from a storm.

Kaitiakitanga is a Māori idea. Share it as their word and value, simply and respectfully, and invite Māori families to share if they wish.

Where this value comes from

In Aotearoa New Zealand, Māori speak of kaitiakitanga: being a guardian of the land, the sea and living things, looking after them as those before us did, so those who come after can love them too.

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Family letters

Cut apart and send home in the family's language, or copy the text into your newsletter.



English

Today we read The Littlest Guardian, a story about looking after the places we love. Tama, the littlest blue penguin, clears his colony's path one stick at a time, even though it isn't his mess. At home, choose one small place to look after together this week, like a plant or a shelf, and start little. You can watch or read the story together for free at doubleadventure.ca.



Français

Aujourd'hui, nous avons lu Le Plus Petit Gardien, une histoire sur le soin des lieux que l'on aime. Tama, le plus petit des manchots bleus, dégage le chemin de sa colonie un bâton à la fois, même si ce n'est pas son désordre. À la maison, choisissez ensemble un petit endroit à soigner cette semaine, comme une plante ou une étagère, et commencez petit. Vous pouvez lire ou regarder l'histoire gratuitement sur doubleadventure.ca.



Español

Hoy leímos un cuento sobre cuidar los lugares que amamos. Tama, el pingüino azul más pequeño, despeja el camino de su colonia palito a palito, aunque el desorden no sea suyo. En casa, elijan juntos un lugar pequeño para cuidar esta semana, como una planta o un estante, y empiecen poco a poco. Pueden leer o ver el cuento gratis en doubleadventure.ca.

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Family letters

Continued.



Deutsch

Heute haben wir eine Geschichte darüber gelesen, auf die Orte aufzupassen, die wir lieben. Tama, der kleinste Zwergpinguin, räumt den Weg seiner Kolonie Stöckchen für Stöckchen frei, obwohl die Unordnung nicht von ihm ist. Suchen Sie sich zu Hause diese Woche gemeinsam einen kleinen Ort zum Pflegen aus, etwa eine Pflanze oder ein Regal, und fangen Sie klein an. Die Geschichte gibt es kostenlos auf doubleadventure.ca.



Italiano

Oggi abbiamo letto una storia sul prendersi cura dei luoghi che amiamo. Tama, il più piccolo dei pinguini blu, libera il sentiero della sua colonia un rametto alla volta, anche se il disordine non è suo. A casa, scegliete insieme un piccolo posto da curare questa settimana, come una pianta o uno scaffale, e cominciate in piccolo. Potete leggere o guardare la storia gratis su doubleadventure.ca.

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Exit tickets

Read each line aloud. Children tick what they can do and circle a face.
Four tickets per page.

Name _____

Guardianship: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

Guardianship: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

Guardianship: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

Guardianship: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

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Home activity pack, ages 3 to 7

The Littlest Guardian

Twelve pages to color, cut, trace, make and talk about, all from the story.
The value in this book: guardianship.

For use in your own home. Please don't share the file or post it online.

For grown-ups

Read the story first, then pick one page a day. Each page takes 10 to 20 minutes. There are no wrong answers.

The big idea

Look after the places that look after you, a little every day, even if the mess isn't yours.

Say it together

Pitter-pat, pitter-pat.

Five words from the story

Word	What it means	Do it
path	a little track you walk along	walk two fingers across your arm
storm	strong wind and rain	wave your arms like wind
driftwood	wood the sea brings onto the beach	hold your arms out like a log
colony	a big group of animals that live together	wave your arms to show lots of friends
look after	to take care of something	hug your arms around something

A gentle note

Safety first for any tidy-up outdoors: gloves, a grown-up, and never touch anything sharp, glass, needles or fishing line.

Don't blame people for the mess or lecture about pollution. In the story, the mess comes from a storm.

What you need

Crayons, a pencil, scissors, glue or tape, a few craft sticks or straws, and the book (or read it free on screen at doubleadventure.ca).

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Meet the friends

Cut out each card along the dashed line. Tape a craft stick on the back and you have a puppet. Act out the story!



Tama

Little penguin (kororā)

The littlest guardian of the path home



Aroha

Rakiura tokoeka (Stewart Island kiwi)

Tama's strong-legged best friend



The three chicks

Little penguin chicks

The next little guardians

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How did they feel?

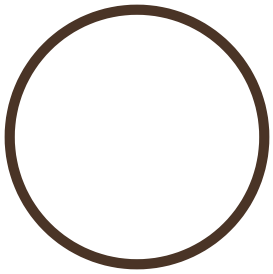
Feelings change during a story. Talk about each moment, then draw how the character felt.

Moment 1

The penguins waddle home up the sandy path.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

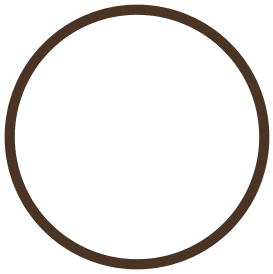


Moment 2

‘Then I’ll start little.’

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

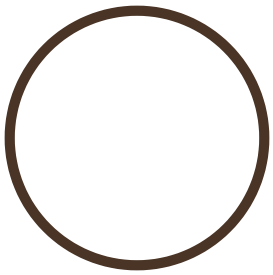


Moment 3

The colony walks home; nobody trips.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm



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Story in order

Color the pictures. Write 1, 2 and 3 in the boxes to show what happened first, next and last. Then cut them out and tell the story.



Color me ☐



Color me ☐



Color me ☐

Tell it in your own words

First, _____

Then, _____

At the end, _____

For grown-ups: the pictures come from the start, the middle and the end of the book. Younger children can just point and tell.

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Trace the words

Trace each word with a pencil. Then try writing it on your own in the empty space.

path a little track you walk along

path path

storm strong wind and rain

storm storm

driftwood wood the sea brings onto the beach

driftwood

Tama the hero of the story

Tama Tama

Write your name

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Draw your own story

Tama showed guardianship. Draw a time when you showed guardianship too, or a time you could.



Tell a grown-up: What happened? How did you feel? How did the other person feel?

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Make and do

Pick one to try today. Each one comes straight from the story.

Glowing shell edges

You need: White paper, scissors, a dark display board

Cut and decorate white shells. Line the edges of a paper path on the board so ‘everyone can find their way home’.

Start little

Pick up three pieces of litter on your next walk, with a grown-up and gloves. Little things add up!

Penguin waddle

Keep your arms by your sides like flippers and waddle across the room. Can you do it in a line, like a raft of penguins coming home?

Sniff like a kiwi

Hide something smelly, like an orange peel, under a cup. Can you find it with your nose and eyes closed?

Draw what you made

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The real animals

The animals in The Littlest Guardian are based on real ones. Here is something true about each of them.



Tama

Little penguin (kororā)

Little penguins use their paddle-like flippers to 'fly' through the water at up to 6 km/h.



Aroha

Rakiura tokoeka (Stewart Island kiwi)

A kiwi egg is about 20% of its mother's weight, and six times bigger than normal for a bird its size. The tokoeka's egg is pale green and about 13 cm long.



The three chicks

Little penguin chicks

In its first year, a young little penguin can travel more than 1,000 km.

Story or real?

Real little penguins really do walk the same path home every night, all in a group. But a penguin with baby fluff on its head would still be a chick waiting at the nest, not out on the beach. And penguins don't tidy paths: people do that job for them.

Where they really live

The book's beach has no name, so we picked one where little penguins live and kiwi really walk on the sand: Stewart Island / Rakiura, at the bottom of New Zealand.

Facts and sources: doubleadventure.ca/heroes/the-littlest-guardian

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Color the story

Color this page from the book. What is happening here?



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Talk together cards

Cut out the cards and keep them in a jar. Pull one out at dinner, in the car or at bedtime.

What kind of bird is this? Have you ever seen a penguin this small? Where do you think it lives?

The Littlest Guardian, talk card 1

Why did Tama say ‘It’s not my mess’ at first?

The Littlest Guardian, talk card 2

What made him change his mind?

The Littlest Guardian, talk card 3

How can someone very small make a big difference?

The Littlest Guardian, talk card 4

Why did Tama keep going even when nobody noticed?

The Littlest Guardian, talk card 5

What place do you love that you could look after?

The Littlest Guardian, talk card 6

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Guardianship hero

This is to say that

_____

showed guardianship, just like Tama.

Pitter-pat, pitter-pat.

_____ _____

Signed Date

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